Code with Cisco:
Get. Set. Code.

Complete Process

Why Apply

- Networking opportunities with Cisco employees at Bengaluru Campus.
- Expand your technical and leadership capabilities through courses, certifications, and experiences.
- Fast Tracked Interview Opportunities—your ticket to a career at Cisco.

Stage	Start Date & Time	End Date & Time
Registration	01 Jun 26	
Online assessment	25 Jun 26	
Top 75 Contestants Announced	30 Jun 26	
Cisco-Sponsored Travel to Bangalore	15 July 2026	
In person Code-a-thon	16 July 2026	17 July 2026

~30K applied → ~23K appeared → 75 shortlisted for codeathon + interviews.

Eligibility Criteria:

Whether you are from any college, degree, or department, your potential is all that matters. There are no barriers based on CGPA, specialization, or location

Code with Cisco is open to all degree programs and branches, for candidates based in India who are passing out in 2027, with no backlogs!

Registration

Individual registrations are required. Team formation will be assigned by Cisco.

You can only register once. Multiple registrations are not allowed and will lead to disqualification.

if a major correction is needed, please contact our support team at support_code_with_cisco@cisco.com.

The specific roles for each program will be detailed in the registration form.

Locations (hybrid)

Available in 12 locations

- Bangalore, India
- Chennai, India
- Gurgaon, India
- Hyderabad, Telangāna, India
- Kolkata, India
- Lucknow, India
- Mumbai, India
- New Delhi, Delhi, India
- Noida, Delhi, India
- Pune, India
- Thane, India
- Vijayawada, India

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Get referrals for better chances.

Software Engineer – Networking Protocols

- Solid understanding of computer science fundamentals and software engineering
- Fundamentals of TCP/IP networking fundamentals, concepts of routing, switching.
- Basics of routers, switches, network debugging tools, techniques, hands on will be a big plus.
- Fundamentals of security technologies like Firewall, IPS/IDS, VPN, Inspections, IPsec, TLS etc., Conceptual understanding of data security, threat vectors, mechanisms, actors and landscape will be a big plus.
- Strong knowledge of programming and scripting languages like python. Strong programming skills inclined towards optimization and performance.
- Familiar with more than one development environment, well-versed with at least one.
- Strong testing inclination to ensure programs are comprehensive and well tested for all use cases. Possess creative problem-solving skills and excellent troubleshooting/debugging skills.

Software Engineer – Application Software

- Solid understanding of computer science fundamentals and software engineering
- Fundamentals of TCP/IP networking fundamentals, concepts of routing, switching.
- Strong knowledge of programming and scripting languages like python.
- Solid fundamentals of object-oriented design and programming.
- Ability to think towards scaling applications to the cloud.
- Strong testing inclination to ensure programs are comprehensive and well tested for all use cases. Hands on exposure to open source, mobile application development will be a big plus.
- Exposure to debugging application programs along with development and debugging tools. Familiar with more than one development environment, well-versed with at least one.
- Interest in User experience and User interface design and development.

Software Engineer – Embedded and Systems Development

- Solid understanding of computer science fundamentals and software engineering
- Strong knowledge of programming and scripting languages like python. Exposure to kernel programming, user space, system space.
- Very strong fundamentals of operating systems. Exposure to device drivers, BSPs will be a plus.
- Fundamentals of system level debugging techniques and exposure to tools used. Strong programming skills with emphasis on system programming.

Assessment Round

- Individual (no teams)
- Combination of multiple-choice questions and coding challenges.
- Test duration is 90 minutes with a login window of 30 minutes on the scheduled date & time.
- No negative markings
- Remotely proctored using AI-based monitoring and video proctoring to ensure integrity. Any malpractice/plagiarism flag will lead to disqualification.
- Assessment date and time cannot be rescheduled.
- Results will be announced in a phased manner, basis the requirement.
- Selected candidates will be contacted with further instructions, like details on the next stages, such as Code-a-thon, interviews, etc
- Previous Year Questions on next slide

Questions in Assessment Round

- Around 40 MCQs based on **CS fundamentals** and a strong focus on **networking concepts**, as Cisco is a networking company. Along with DSA based 2 coding questions

- MCQs
    a. Computer Networks (V. imp): OSI Model, TCP vs UDP, HTTP/HTTPS, DNS, Routing vs Switching, IP Addressing, Subnetting basics, ARP, DHCP
    b. Operating Systems: Process vs Thread, Deadlock, Scheduling, Virtual Memory, Paging, Synchronization
    c. DBMS: Keys, Normalization, Joins, Transactions, ACID
    d. OOP: Inheritance, Polymorphism, Abstraction, Encapsulation
    e. Aptitude: Percentages, Profit & Loss, Probability, Permutation & Combination, Logical Reasoning, Number Series, Puzzles
- DSA: **Hashing > Sliding Window > Binary Search > Graphs > Trees > Greedy > Heaps > Bit Manipulation > DP > DSU**
    a. Graphs: BFS, DFS, Connected Components, Cycle Detection (Directed & Undirected), Topological Sort, Multi-Source BFS, Shortest Path (BFS), Dijkstra, Minimum Spanning Tree (Kruskal/Prim), Bridges, DSU (Union Find), Grid BFS/DFS
    b. Trees: DFS Traversals, Level Order Traversal, Tree Diameter, Lowest Common Ancestor (LCA), Tree DP Basics
    c. Greedy: Interval Scheduling, Meeting Rooms, Minimum Platforms, Sorting + Greedy
    d. Binary Search: Classic Binary Search, Lower Bound, Upper Bound, Binary Search on Answer
    e. Heaps: Min Heap, Max Heap, Top K Elements, Priority Queue Problems
    f. Hashing: Frequency Maps, Hash Sets, Prefix Sum + Hashing, String Parsing/IP Validation
    g. Sliding Window: Fixed Window, Variable Window
    h. DP: 1D DP, Knapsack, LIS, Basic State DP
    i. Bit Manipulation: Counting Set Bits, Bit Masking, XOR properties, Power of 2 checks.

Previous Year Questions

1. Desi QnA: https://www.desiqna.in/tag/cisco_oa
2. 2025 PYQs: https://leetcode.com/discuss/post/7419117/code-with-cisco25-codeathon-interview-in-vzuy/
3. 2025 question: https://www.hackerearth.com/problem/algorithm/alex-and-his-coins-6e1823e6/
4. 2024 Experience: https://medium.com/codess-cafe/cisco-6-month-intern-fte-offer-via-code-with-cisco-off-campus-f4bf8028c6d4
5. 2026 Cisco: https://medium.com/%40programhelp/26ng-conquering-cisco-2026-new-grad-oa-full-interview-experience-a17598264643
6. A to Z guide: https://www.linkedin.com/posts/vikram-gaur-0252aa185_a-to-z-preparation-guide-for-code-with-cisco-activity-7206322773500010497-9bX4/
7. Cisco intern 2026: https://leetcode.com/discuss/post/6146794/cisco-internship-2026-by-anonymous_user-ormq/
8. Cisco OA 2026 Question https://www.reddit.com/r/LeetcodeDesi/comments/1reaa8r/cisco_oa_feb_2026_how_to_solve_ctc35l/

1h 23m left

ALL

20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30

25. Question 25

A distributed system of servers is represented as a tree with *tree_nodes*, numbered from 1 to *tree_nodes*. Moving between directly connected servers takes 1 unit of time.

A process needs to:

- Start at the *start_node* server.
- Complete tasks at servers listed in an array *task_nodes[]* of size *num_tasks* by visitin
servers in any order.
- End at the *end_node* server.

Determine the minimum time required
complete all tasks and reach the *end_n*
server.

Note:

- Edges are bidirectional.
- It is guaranteed that *task_nodes[]* contains distinct elements.
- It is guaranteed that *start_node* is not equal to *end_node* and it is not present in *task_nodes[]*.

Example

tree_nodes = 4
tree_from = [1, 2, 2]
tree_to = [3, 3, 4]
start_node = 1, *end_node* = 2
num_tasks = 1
task_nodes = [4]

Language C++20 | Environment | Autocomplete Ready

```
 *  4. INTEGER_ARRAY task_nodes
 */

/*
 * For the unweighted graph, <name>:
 *
 * 1. The number of nodes is <name>_nodes.
 * 2. The number of edges is <name>_edges.
 * 3. An edge exists between <name>_from[i] and <name>_to[i].
 *
 */


tor<int> tree_to,
```

Line: 78 Col: 6

Run Code | Run Tests | Submit

Test case 0
Test case 1
Test case 2
Test case 3
Test case 4
Test case 5

Input (stdin) | Run as Custom Input | Download

```
5 4
2 3
4 2
3 1
1 5
2
1
2
1
```

Question 23

Problem Description

Your team at a leading technology company is launching a cutting-edge networking product. To generate buzz, you're running a targeted social media campaign. You have a limited marketing **budget** to send premium trial units to a select group of "seed" influencers on a professional network.

Each potential influencer has a different **cost** to engage (e.g., the cost of the trial unit or compensation). Furthermore, not all users in the network are equally valuable to the campaign; each user has an associated **market value** based on their role and influence (e.g., a 'Lead Network Architect' is more valuable than an 'Intern').

Your task is to develop an algorithm that selects the optimal set of seed influencers. The "optimal set" is the one that maximizes the **total market value** of all unique users reached by the campaign, without exceeding the given budget. Influence spreads from the seeds to their friends, their friends-of-friends, and so on, up to a specified **depth d**.

A brute-force approach that checks every possible combination of seeds is computationally infeasible. You will need to devise a more clever heuristic to find a high-quality solution.

Input

Language: C++20

```cpp
vector<int> bfsReach(const vector<vector<int>>&adj,int start,int depth){
            reached.push_back(u);
            if(d==depth)continue;
            for(int nei:adj[u]){
                if(!vis.count(nei)){
                    vis.insert(nei);
                    q.push({nei,d+1});
                }
            }
        }
    return reached;
}


tuple<vector<int>, int, int> solveCampaign(const vector<pair<int, int>>& connections,
```

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Test Results

All Cases | Custom

✓ All available test cases passed

✓ Test Case 1

✓ Test Case 2

Compiler Message

Success

Code a thon

- Top 75 coders selected
- Cisco will cover food, travel, and accommodations.
- Team formation will happen after the assessment and will be managed by Cisco.
- Brush up your basics in coding, problem-solving. Challenges will be based on real-life scenarios.
- Winners will be announced towards the end of the second day of the event on July 17, 2026.

Interviews

- Interviews will be conducted virtually via video conferencing.
- There will be four rounds of interviews
- Desi QnA: https://www.desiqna.in/tag/cisco_oa
- 2025 PYQs: https://leetcode.com/discuss/post/7419117/code-with-cisco25-codeathon-interview-in-vzuy/
- 2025 question: https://www.hackerearth.com/problem/algorithm/alex-and-his-coins-6e1823e6/
- 2024 Experience: https://medium.com/codess-cafe/cisco-6-month-intern-fte-offer-via-code-with-cisco-off-campus-f4bf8028c6d4
- 2026 Cisco: https://medium.com/%40programhelp/26ng-conquering-cisco-2026-new-grad-oa-full-interview-experience-a17598264643
- A to Z guide: https://www.linkedin.com/posts/vikram-gaur-0252aa185_a-to-z-preparation-guide-for-code-with-cisco-activity-7206322773500010497-9bX4/
- Cisco intern 2026: https://leetcode.com/discuss/post/6146794/cisco-internship-2026-by-anonymous_user-ormq/

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Thank You